GUJARAT FLUOROCHEMICALS

nuvama institutional equities

RESULT UPDATE

KEY DATA

Rating	BUY
Sector relative	Outperformer
Price (INR)	3,488
12 month price target (INR)	5,298
52 Week High/Low	4,535/3,100
Market cap (INR bn/USD bn)	383/4.3
Free float (%)	35.0
Avg. daily value traded (INR mn)	646.6

SHAREHOLDING PATTERN

	Sep-25	Jun-25	Mar-25
Promoter	61.39%	62.57%	62.57%
FII	4.36%	4.25%	4.63%
DII	12.73%	11.47%	10.74%
Pledge	0.86%	0.71%	1.36%

FINANCIALS

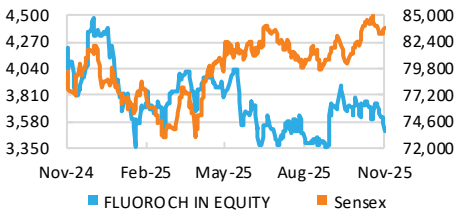
(INR mn)

Year to March	FY25A	FY26E	FY27E	FY28E
Revenue	47,370	56,757	88,052	1,00,491
EBITDA	10,990	16,662	24,021	28,805
Adjusted profit	5,460	8,772	13,807	16,774
Diluted EPS (INR)	49.7	79.9	125.7	152.7
EPS growth (%)	25.5	60.7	57.4	21.5
RoAE (%)	9.5	13.3	18.0	19.2
P/E (x)	80.4	50.1	31.8	26.2
EV/EBITDA (x)	1.8	1.1	0.9	0.8
Dividend yield (%)	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.2

CHANGE IN ESTIMATES

	Revised estimates		% Revision	
Year to March	FY26E	FY27E	FY26E	FY27E
Revenue	56,757	88,052	0.0%	0.0%
EBITDA	16,662	24,021	0.0%	0.0%
Adjusted profit	8,772	13,807	0.0%	0.0%
Diluted EPS (INR)	79.9	125.7	0.0%	0.0%

PRICE PERFORMANCE



Chemical bond: Solid margins in adversity

Gujarat Fluorochemicals (GFL) reported an in-line Q2FY26, but the noteworthy aspect is a solid margin profile despite the interruptions in fluoropolymers caused due to USA tariffs. A rich product mix due to high-value fluoropolymers boosted margin. Sales/EBITDA/PAT grew 1.9%/23.4%/47.9% to INR12.1bn/3.6bn/1.8bn.

The EV products' subsidiary is expected to start dispatching LFP and salts by Q4FY26E while, incrementally, R-32 sales should aid a better H2FY26 than H1FY26. Significant ramp-up in H2FY27E and FY28E would keep growth intact. All in all, we maintain our estimates and the target price at INR5,298, valuing the stock at 40x Q1FY28E.

Strong underlying growth amid temporary tariff overhang

GFL delivered a resilient performance in Q2FY26 despite US tariff-related disruptions that temporarily impacted fluoropolymer sales. The company effectively mitigated this through cost optimisation, improved product mix and partial pass-through of tariffs. With global diversification efforts underway—targeting Japan, Korea and Europe—GFL is positioning its next-generation fluoropolymers across high-value segments such as semiconductors, data centres and AI infrastructure. We expect the company to be able to maintain its 25% growth trajectory in fluoropolymers.

Other growth drivers in near term

Anti-dumping duty recommendation on PTFE can enable GFL to capture a large share of domestic PTFE demand. The company expects a sharp pickup in fluoropolymer exports from Q4FY26 as supply chain normalisation follows recent tariff adjustments. Within fluorochemicals, the R-32 plant commissioning by Nov-25 will drive volume growth and strengthen the refrigerant portfolio. We expect higher R-32 realisations to boost EBITDA margins further.

EV products geared to drive long-term growth

With exports of LiPF6 salts and cathode materials expected to begin Q4FY26 onwards, FY27 should see a solid ramp-up of EV-based products. GFCL will benefit from preference to non-FEOC entities, within which the company stands as the only integrated supplier of battery chemicals. LiPF6 prices have surged to USD17/kg in China, reflecting tightening supply and rising ESS demand. With over INR12bn capex lined up and EBIT breakeven targeted in the EV subsidiary in FY27, the business is entering a monetisation phase.

Financials

Year to March	Q2FY26	Q2FY25	% Change	Q1FY26	% Change
Net Revenue	12,100	11,880	1.9	12,810	(5.5)
EBITDA	3,640	2,950	23.4	3,440	5.8
Adjusted Profit	1,790	1,210	47.9	1,840	(2.7)
Diluted EPS (INR)	16.3	11.0	47.9	16.7	(2.7)

Archit Joshi
Archit.Joshi@nuvama.com

Rohan Ohri
rohan.ohri@nuvama.com

Financial Statements

Income Statement (INR mn)

Year to March	FY25A	FY26E	FY27E	FY28E
Total operating income	47,370	56,757	88,052	1,00,491
Gross profit	32,240	38,311	58,554	66,827
Employee costs	4,330	4,763	5,335	5,975
Other expenses	16,920	16,886	29,199	32,047
EBITDA	10,990	16,662	24,021	28,805
Depreciation	3,550	4,072	4,672	5,272
Less: Interest expense	1,470	1,495	1,560	1,800
Add: Other income	1,160	600	620	632
Profit before tax	7,130	11,696	18,409	22,366
Prov for tax	1,670	2,924	4,602	5,591
Less: Other adj	0	0	0	0
Reported profit	5,460	8,772	13,807	16,774
Less: Excp.item (net)	0	0	0	0
Adjusted profit	5,460	8,772	13,807	16,774
Diluted shares o/s	110	110	110	110
Adjusted diluted EPS	49.7	79.9	125.7	152.7
DPS (INR)	3.0	4.0	5.0	6.0
Tax rate (%)	23.4	25.0	25.0	25.0

Balance Sheet (INR mn)

Year to March	FY25A	FY26E	FY27E	FY28E
Share capital	110	110	110	110
Reserves	72,420	80,752	94,010	1,10,125
Shareholders funds	72,530	80,862	94,120	1,10,235
Minority interest	460	460	460	460
Borrowings	19,880	22,880	22,880	22,880
Trade payables	6,060	7,388	11,815	13,484
Other liabs & prov	5,660	5,660	5,660	5,660
Total liabilities	1,06,090	1,17,650	1,35,334	1,53,119
Net block	40,400	48,328	53,657	58,385
Intangible assets	960	960	960	960
Capital WIP	15,240	15,240	15,240	15,240
Total fixed assets	56,600	64,528	69,857	74,585
Non current inv	110	110	110	110
Cash/cash equivalent	2,220	780	870	3,390
Sundry debtors	11,970	14,342	19,838	22,640
Loans & advances	250	914	1,418	1,618
Other assets	28,570	30,533	36,800	44,333
Total assets	1,06,090	1,17,650	1,35,334	1,53,119

Important Ratios (%)

Year to March	FY25A	FY26E	FY27E	FY28E
Fluoropolymer growth(%)	12.8	29.8	19.3	14.9
Fluorochemicals growth(%)	14.7	17.4	27.9	(2.1)
Bulk chemicals growth(%)	(2.9)	0.6	6.1	0
EBITDA margin (%)	23.2	29.4	27.3	28.7
Net profit margin (%)	11.5	15.5	15.7	16.7
Revenue growth (% YoY)	10.7	19.8	55.1	14.1
EBITDA growth (% YoY)	15.1	51.6	44.2	19.9
Adj. profit growth (%)	25.5	60.7	57.4	21.5

Free Cash Flow (INR mn)

Year to March	FY25A	FY26E	FY27E	FY28E
Reported profit	5,460	8,772	13,807	16,774
Add: Depreciation	3,550	4,072	4,672	5,272
Interest (net of tax)	1,470	1,495	1,560	1,800
Others	330	(1,100)	0	0
Less: Changes in WC	(5,250)	(3,671)	(7,840)	(8,866)
Operating cash flow	5,560	9,567	12,198	14,979
Less: Capex	(8,181)	(12,000)	(10,000)	(10,000)
Free cash flow	(2,621)	(2,433)	2,198	4,979

Assumptions (%)

Year to March	FY25A	FY26E	FY27E	FY28E
GDP (YoY %)	6.5	6.0	6.5	7.0
Repo rate (%)	6.3	5.0	5.0	5.5
USD/INR (average)	84.6	86.5	86.0	85.5
Battery chemicals growth (%)	0	0	900.0	32.5
Capex (INR mn)	8,181.3	12,000.0	10,000.0	10,000.0
Tax rate(%)	23.4	25.0	25.0	25.0

Key Ratios

Year to March	FY25A	FY26E	FY27E	FY28E
RoE (%)	9.5	13.3	18.0	19.2
RoCE (%)	11.4	15.2	20.3	21.8
Inventory days	369	336	248	289
Receivable days	75	66	55	62
Payable days	146	111	83	104
Working cap (% sales)	49.1	55.1	39.7	42.6
Gross debt/equity (x)	0.4	0.3	0.3	0.2
Net debt/equity (x)	0.3	0.2	0.3	0.2
Interest coverage (x)	5.1	8.4	12.4	13.1

Valuation Metrics

Year to March	FY25A	FY26E	FY27E	FY28E
Diluted P/E (x)	80.4	50.1	31.8	26.2
Price/BV (x)	6.1	5.4	4.7	4.0
EV/EBITDA (x)	1.8	1.1	0.9	0.8
Dividend yield (%)	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.2

Valuation Drivers

Year to March	FY25A	FY26E	FY27E	FY28E
EPS growth (%)	25.5	60.7	57.4	21.5
RoE (%)	9.5	13.3	18.0	19.2
EBITDA growth (%)	15.1	51.6	44.2	19.9
Payout ratio (%)	6.0	5.0	4.0	3.9

Source: Company and Nuvama estimates

Exhibit 1: Quarterly financial snapshot (INR mn)

Year to March	*Sep-25*	Sept-24	%YoY	Jun-25	%QoQ	FY26E	FY27E	FY28E
Revenue	***12,100***	11,880	1.9	12,810	-5.5	56,757	88,052	1,00,491
Raw material costs	***3,490***	3,740	-6.7	4,470	-21.9	18,446	29,497	33,665
Gross profit	***8,610***	8,140	5.8	8,340	3.2	38,311	58,554	66,827
Employee costs	***1,280***	1,100	16.4	1,060	20.8	4,763	5,335	5,975
Other expenses	***3,690***	4,090	-9.8	3,840	-3.9	16,886	29,199	32,047
Total operating expenses	***4,970***	5,190	-4.2	4,900	1.4	21,649	34,533	38,022
EBITDA	***3,640***	2,950	23.4	3,440	5.8	16,662	24,021	28,805
Depreciation	***910***	900	1.1	900	1.1	4,072	4,672	5,272
EBIT	***2,730***	2,050	33.2	2,540	7.5	12,591	19,349	23,533
Less: Interest Expense	***330***	420	-21.4	300	10.0	1,495	1,560	1,800
Add : Other Income	***60***	90	-33.3	230	-73.9	600	620	632
Profit Before Tax	***2,460***	1,720	43.0	2,470	-0.4	11,696	18,409	22,366
Less: Provision for Tax	***670***	510	31.4	630	6.3	2,924	4,602	5,591
Reported Profit	***1,790***	1,210	47.9	1,840	-2.7	8,772	13,807	16,774
Adjusted Profit	***1,790***	1,210	47.9	1,840	-2.7	8,772	13,807	16,774
No. of Diluted shares outstanding (mn)	***110***	110		110		110	110	110
Adjusted Diluted EPS	***16***	11	47.9	17	-2.7	80	126	153
As % of revenues								
COGS	***28.8***	31.5	-263.9	34.9	-6.1	32.5	33.5	33.5
Gross profit	***71.2***	68.5	263.9	65.1	6.1	67.5	66.5	66.5
Employee costs	***10.6***	9.3	131.9	8.3	2.3	8.4	6.1	5.9
Other expenses	***30.5***	34.4	-393.2	30.0	0.5	29.8	33.2	31.9
Total operating expenses	***41.1***	43.7	-261.2	38.3	2.8	38.1	39.2	37.8
EBITDA	***30.1***	24.8	525.1	26.9	322.9	29.4	27.3	28.7
Net profit	***14.8***	10.2	460.8	14.4	0.4	15.5	15.7	16.7

Source: Nuvama Research, Company

Q2FY26 conference call takeaways

Business overview

- Sales growth in Q2FY26 was impacted by uncertainty surrounding U.S. tariffs; however, this is expected to ease in the coming quarters. The company benefited from product mix optimization and ongoing cost control measures, which supported profitability.
- Management guided that EBITDA margins are likely to improve further as higher-value products scale up and operational efficiencies strengthen.

Sales growth driver

- Value-added grades of new fluoropolymers, particularly those used in semiconductor and other high-end applications, continue to be the key margin and growth drivers. The company expects sustained demand momentum across these specialty segments as global adoption increases.

Bulk chemicals – Chloromethanes

- Chloromethanes benefited from both higher realisations and improved volumes during the quarter.
- Demand remained firm, supporting overall performance in the bulk chemical segment.

Fluorochemicals

- **R-22**: Revenues were lower due to quota reduction and seasonal demand weakness.
- **R-32**: Capacity of 20,000TPA is expected to be achieved by March 2026, with a meaningful utilisation uptick anticipated in FY27E.
- **R-125**: Sales were adversely impacted by US tariff-related uncertainty.

Fluoropolymers

- **PTFE**: Anti-dumping duties (ADD) expectation can enable the company to capture 50–60% of the import market. Adequate monomer capacity is in place, and polymer capacity is being expanded to meet growing domestic demand.
- **Market outlook**: While high U.S. tariffs affected sales in the quarter, PTFE remains exempt, minimizing direct impact. Management indicated that from Q4FY26 onward, sales are expected to pick up sharply as markets normalize and export channels diversify.

Other Comments

- Discussions are ongoing regarding tariff pass-through and partial absorption strategies. The company is exploring alternative markets to offset the U.S. tariff impact.

GFCL EV products

- Revenue contribution from the EV Products segment is expected from Q4FY26 onward, with initial focus on export markets.
- **Electrolyte and salt**: Salt exports are likely to begin first, with electrolytes primarily catering to the U.S. market.

- **Cathode (LFP)**: Initial sales will target overseas customers. Production currently uses iron phosphate as the precursor for LFP manufacturing, with plans to transition to battery-grade phosphoric acid over time.
- Management expects commercial sales to begin within the next few months.
- $LiPF_6$ prices have risen sharply from USD10/kg to USD17/kg while the LFP cathode active material (CAM) line has been commissioned.
- Qualification for binders is progressing well, indicating strong forward momentum in the energy storage materials segment.

Guidance

- **Debt**: A USD125mn line is available for funding EV Products capex, reducing the immediate need for equity infusion. Future equity dilution may occur during the IPO phase.
- **Capex:** Over INR12bn in EV products' capex is planned for FY27.
- **Growth**: The company maintained its 25% growth guidance for fluoropolymers.
- **Profitability**: Management indicated that the EV Products subsidiary could achieve EBIT breakeven in the near term.

Company Description

Incorporated in 1989, Gujarat Fluorochemicals (GFL) started its operations with refrigerant manufacturing unit at Ranjitnagar, Gujarat, India. Over the years, the company has diversified its operations across different chemical products including caustic soda, chloromethane, which come as by-products from backward integration of chlorine (for chloromethane plant) and chloroform (for R-22), which are key feedstock apart from AHF (anhydrous hydrofluoric acid). Company has also diversified its presence in ref. gas after entering into R-32, R-125 and R-410a, which have been replacing R-22 in residential ACs. In 2007, company marked its entry in fluoropolymers (PTFE) and over last few years, GFL has diversified its portfolio of Fluoropolymers comprising PTFE, PFA, FEP, FKM, PVDF and Fluoropolymer Additives. It is the among the leading fluoropolymer producers in India with major cliental base across Europe and USA. GFL is now venturing into battery materials business to support the growing EV battery and storage battery infrastructure.

Investment Theme

Leading player in Fluorine chemistry

GFL has over three decades of expertise in fluorine chemistry and is among the leading players in the country, along with SRF and Navin Fluorine. GFL has successfully expanded its product basket by getting into newer chemistry, creating a niche product portfolio of fluoropolymers. To leverage its fluorine chemical capability, the company has also entered into fluorine based speciality chemicals to cater to agrochemicals, pharma and polymer industry.

Fluoropolymers offers huge future growth potential

Fluoropolymers are integral building blocks of the modern world. The applicability ranges from automobiles to telecommunications. Their unique properties power inventions that lead industries towards efficiency and better performance. The global market size for fluoropolymers are estimated at USD8bn and growing at 7-10% (as per various global research agencies).

EV Products – Next leg of growth

Gujarat fluorochemicals' venture into battery chemicals will be one of the first of a kind set-up in India to support the EV powertrain and energy storage applications. The company is expected to capture ~40% of the EV battery's value by manufacturing cathode, binders and electrolytes & its salts. With giga-watt hour factories being set-up in India, GFL is expected to take massive strides in the battery business.

Key Risks

A key risk to GFL's investment thesis is delays in putting up battery plants in India, which can put pressure on operating leverage and thereby cash-flows. The recent tariff announcements by USA also put a good chunk of GFL's portfolio at risk, which can impede margins. Sourcing of fluorspar, and its unavailability can leave operations strained. Fluctuations in foreign exchange, large capacity creations of refrigerant gases and fluoropolymers in China are few other risks to the business.

Additional Data

Management

Chairman	Devendra Jain
MD	Vivek Jain
CFO	Manoj Aggarwal
Auditor	Patunkar & Associates

Holdings – Top 10*

	% Holding		% Holding
DSP Investment	2.03	Nippon life	1.15
HDFC AMC	1.57	Black rock	0.53
Motilal oswal	1.54	Axis asset mana	0.45
Vanguard Group	1.32	Dimensional fun	0.39
Mirae asset Glo	1.17	ICICI pru	0.14

**Latest public data*

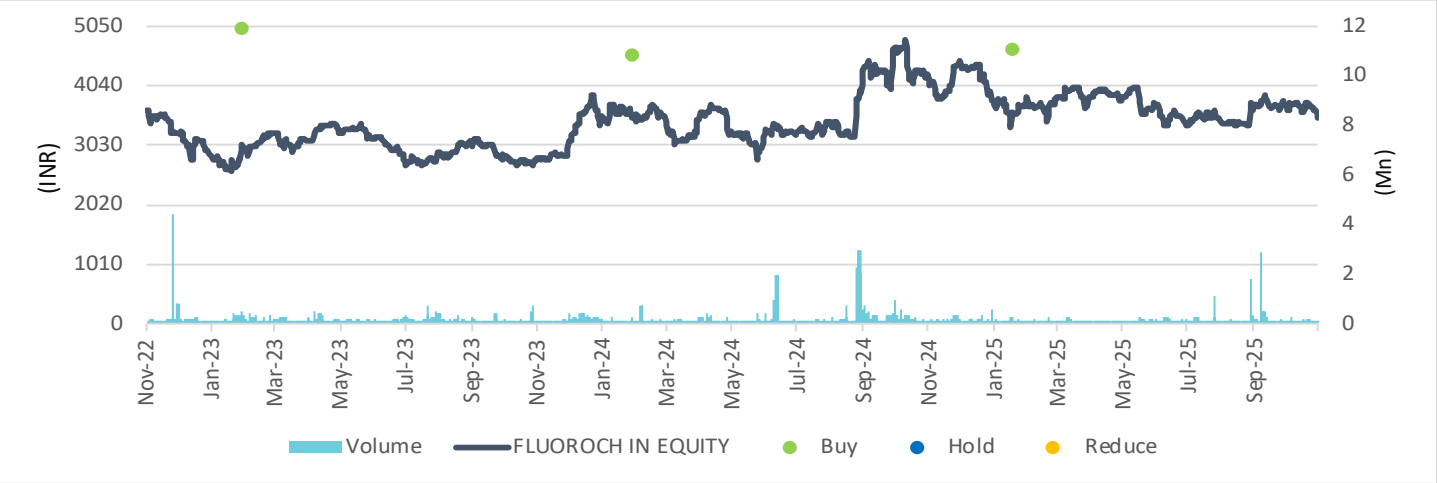
Recent Company Research

Date	Title	Price	Reco
22-Sep-25	ADD leg-up for growth; *Company Update*	3,801	Buy
05-Aug-25	Fluoropolymers find their flow; *Result Update*	3,486	Buy
27-May-25	Steady quarter; *Result Update*	3,949	Buy

Recent Sector Research

Date	Name of Co./Sector	Title
10-Nov-25	Fine Organics	Growth stagnates; valuation comfortable; *Result Update*
07-Nov-25	Aarti Industries	Lofty valuations for weak return ratios; *Result Update*
28-Oct-25	SRF	Solid performance; misses estimates ; *Result Update*

Rating and Daily Volume Interpretation



Source: Bloomberg, Nuvama research

Rating Rationale & Distribution: Nuvama Research

Rating	Expected absolute returns over 12 months	Rating Distribution
Buy	15%	205
Hold	<15% and >-5%	68
Reduce	<-5%	37

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Abneesh Roy
Head of Research Committee
Abneesh.Roy@nuvama.com

ABNEESH KUMAR ROY

Digitally signed by ABNEESH KUMAR ROY
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